

Conflict-of-Interest Policy

Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order

Conflict-of-Interest Policy

Purpose The purpose of this Conflict-of-Interest Policy is to protect the interests of Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order whenever the Order is contemplating entering into a transaction, arrangement, compensation decision, grant decision, contract, purchase, sale, lease, reimbursement, fundraising relationship, or other matter that might benefit the private interest of a director, officer, key person, committee member, or related person.

This policy is intended to promote integrity, transparency, and faithful stewardship of the Order's charitable, educational, religious, historical, and fraternal mission. It is also intended to help ensure that the Order avoids impermissible private benefit, private inurement, self-dealing, or the appearance of impropriety.

Persons Covered This policy applies to directors, officers, Board members, committee members with Board-delegated powers, key employees, grand officers or ceremonial officers, and any other person who can influence financial, operational, contractual, disciplinary, fundraising, grantmaking, or governance decisions of the Order.

Definition of Conflict of Interest A conflict of interest exists when a covered person has a direct or indirect financial interest, personal interest, family interest, business interest, or loyalty interest that could interfere with, or reasonably appear to interfere with, that person's independent judgment on behalf of the Order. A conflict may be actual, potential, or perceived.

Financial Interest A person has a financial interest if the person, directly or indirectly, through business, investment, compensation arrangement, or family relationship: has an ownership or investment interest in an entity with which the Order has or is considering a transaction; has a compensation arrangement with the Order or with any entity or individual with which the Order has or is considering a transaction; expects to receive gifts, commissions, referral fees, discounts, consulting fees, expense reimbursements beyond ordinary policy, or any other economic benefit from a transaction involving the Order; has a family member or closely associated person who may receive such benefit; or has any other material economic interest that could affect the person's judgment.

Other Interests A conflict may also arise when a covered person owes loyalty to another nonprofit, business, church, order, lodge, chapter, school, vendor, donor, or advocacy group whose interests may diverge from those of the Order; is involved in selecting, disciplining, promoting, or compensating a family member, close friend, romantic partner, business associate, or rival; uses Order office, title, prestige, regalia, or access for personal advantage; competes with the Order for opportunities, grants, donations, contracts, speaking engagements, event venues, memberships, or intellectual property rights; or uses confidential information of the Order for personal

or outside advantage.

Duty to Disclose Each covered person has an affirmative duty to disclose promptly, fully, and in writing the existence and nature of any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest. Disclosure must be made before initial discussion of the matter whenever possible, before any vote or formal recommendation, as soon as the conflict is discovered if it was not known earlier, and annually through a written disclosure statement.

Procedure After Disclosure After disclosure, the interested person shall present the material facts to the Board, committee, or other authorized decision-making body, may answer questions requested by that body, and shall then leave the meeting during discussion and voting unless the disinterested body requests limited factual input. The interested person shall not improperly influence deliberations. The remaining disinterested decision-makers shall determine whether a conflict exists and, if so, how the matter shall proceed.

Recusal If a conflict exists, the interested person shall be recused from voting on the matter, participating in substantive deliberation, being counted for purposes of quorum on that specific matter if required by applicable law or Board rule, and supervising the implementation of a transaction from which the interested person benefits unless expressly approved with safeguards.

Determining Whether a Transaction May Proceed A transaction or arrangement involving a conflict may proceed only if the disinterested directors or authorized committee members determine, after reasonable inquiry, that the transaction is fair, reasonable, and in the best interests of the Order; that the Order cannot obtain a more advantageous arrangement with reasonable effort under the circumstances, or that the transaction remains appropriate despite available alternatives; that the transaction furthers, or at least does not undermine, the charitable and nonprofit purposes of the Order; and that the transaction does not result in impermissible private inurement, excess benefit, or misuse of charitable assets.

Compensation Decisions Any decision regarding compensation, stipends, consulting fees, housing, expense allowances, honoraria, or other economic benefits for a director, officer, or key person shall be made only by disinterested decision-makers. The decision-making body should review comparable compensation data when appropriate, consider the duties actually performed, record the basis for its determination, and approve only compensation that is reasonable and not excessive. No person may approve his or her own compensation.

Gifts, Corporate Opportunities, and Confidentiality Covered persons shall not solicit or accept gifts, favors, loans, discounts, travel, entertainment, or hospitality that could reasonably appear to influence Order decisions. Modest customary courtesies may be accepted if permitted by Board policy and if they do not compromise independent judgment. Any substantial gift, honorarium, or sponsored travel connected to Order business must be disclosed.

A covered person shall not take for personal benefit an opportunity that properly belongs to the Order, including a donation or grant opportunity, a sponsorship or fundraising relationship, a publishing or

branding opportunity using the Order's identity, a chance to acquire property or archival material of interest to the Order, or an event or venue opportunity being pursued by the Order.

A covered person shall not use confidential or nonpublic information obtained through the Order for personal gain or to benefit another person or entity. This includes donor information, membership information, internal disputes, disciplinary matters, budgets, contracts, strategic plans, and unpublished historical or educational materials.

Minutes and Documentation *The minutes of the Board or committee meeting shall reflect the name of the interested person, the nature of the disclosed conflict, the material facts disclosed, whether the interested person left the meeting during discussion and vote, the names of persons present for discussion and vote, any alternatives considered, and the final decision and basis for concluding the transaction was fair and in the Order's best interests.*

Annual Disclosure Statements *Each covered person shall annually sign a statement affirming that the person has received, read, and understands this policy, agrees to comply with it, has disclosed all known actual, potential, or perceived conflicts, and understands that the Order is a nonprofit organization that must operate in furtherance of its exempt purposes.*

Violations *If the Board or authorized committee has reasonable cause to believe a covered person has failed to disclose a conflict, it shall inform the person of the basis for that belief and provide an opportunity to explain. If, after investigation, the Board or committee determines that a violation occurred, it may take corrective action, including warning, required recusal, rescission or renegotiation of a transaction where lawful and practical, removal from committee assignment, removal from office, suspension of membership privileges, expulsion if authorized by the bylaws, or referral to legal or tax counsel when appropriate.*

Administration and Adoption *The Chancellor or Secretary shall maintain signed annual disclosure statements and conflict records in the corporate records of the Order. The Board may adopt forms, procedures, and guidance to implement this policy.*

This Conflict-of-Interest Policy was adopted by the Board of Directors of Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order on the ____ day of _____, 20____, and shall remain in effect until amended or repealed by the Board.

[Name], Grand Master / President / Chair

[Name], Chancellor / Secretary

Annual Disclosure Statement *I certify that I have received a copy of the Conflict-of-Interest Policy of Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order; I have read and understand the policy; I agree to comply with it; I understand that the Order is a nonprofit organization and must engage primarily in activities that accomplish one or more of its tax-exempt purposes; and, to the best of my knowledge, I have disclosed all actual, potential, or perceived conflicts of interest, including business interests, compensation arrangements, family relationships, loyalty conflicts, or other matters that could influence my judgment.*

Disclosures: _____

Signature: _____ Name: _____ Office/Role: _____
_____ Date: _____